

Farming forests

Trees helped our ancestors to survive by providing them with food in the form of fruit and nuts. Much of the fruit we eat now has changed from the wild-grown food of our ancestors' day, because we grow it in artificial forests known as orchards. Some nuts and other foods, however, are still harvested from the wild.

Ancient apples

The ancestors of modern apples were tiny, sour-tasting crab apples. After thousands of years of selection by farmers, who chose trees with the largest, sweetest fruit, we now enjoy delicious apples from farmed trees.



Crab apples still grow in woodlands and hedgerows.



The world's favorite bean?

More than 2,000 years ago, people living in the rain forests of Central America discovered the fruit of the cocoa tree. Today this tree is grown around the world for its seeds, known as "beans." These are the source of all the world's chocolate!